

STEVEN KOTSCHEGAROW

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SUMMARY

Software Engineer - B.S. in Computer Science (University of South Dakota, May 2025; GPA 3.62). Built a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) chatbot on Azure indexing 6,000+ documents (answers in under 3 seconds; about 20x faster) and automated daily API workflows, saving ~700 hours per year. Strengths: Python, Java, JavaScript, React, SQL, Spring Boot, Pandas, NumPy, SciPy, Azure/AWS, Git/GitHub.

EDUCATION

University of South Dakota - B.S., Computer Science (AI Specialization) | May 2025 | GPA 3.62

Selected coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms; AI/ML; Systems; Machine Organization; Information Retrieval; Discrete Structures; Calculus III; Probability & Statistics; High-Performance Computing; Internet of Things.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, JavaScript/TypeScript, SQL, C/C++, HTML/CSS, Bash

Frameworks/Libraries: React, Next.js, Vue, React Native, Spring Boot, Pandas, NumPy, SciPy

Cloud & DevOps: Azure, AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, Vercel, Git, GitHub

Databases: Relational - MySQL, PostgreSQL; Non-relational - MongoDB (Atlas)

Tools/Platforms: Azure (Cognitive Search, Blob Storage); OpenAI API; AWS (EC2, S3, CloudFront, CloudWatch)

AI & Dev Tools: Cursor, Cursor 2.0 (agents), Kiro, Windsurf, VS Code, Copilot

Practices: Agile methodology (Scrum, Kanban)

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Intern - University Client (confidential) | Jan 2025 - May 2025

- Shipped an Azure Cognitive Search + GPT-4 RAG chatbot indexing 6,000+ internal/regulatory docs.
- Reduced time-to-information by ~95%, delivering answers in under 3 seconds.
- Automated daily API workflows to Azure Blob with retries, alerts, and idempotency; eliminated manual steps and saved ~700 hours/year.
- Diagnosed and fixed a recurring failure at ~4,500 PDF pages that a teammate couldn't resolve; after the fix, successfully fetched and stored 6,000+ pages with zero errors and higher throughput.
- Met Safety Compliance and IT at HQ; pitched solutions, handled Q&A, set a phased rollout.
- Observed meetings between management and the CEO and answered questions within my area of competence.

Walmart - Fresh Cap Associate | Jan 2020 - Jul 2023

- Managed perishable inventory (FIFO); kept accurate counts, clear handoffs, and food-safety compliance.

PROJECTS

- Created automation scripts using official APIs (Twitter API v2, Spotify Web API, Instagram Graph/Basic Display) to automate repetitive pulls and fetch targeted data (2021)
- Hosted static portfolio on Amazon S3 with CloudFront (HTTPS, caching) (2022)
- Small-Business Website - Built a responsive site with dynamic navigation. (2023)
- MERN CRUD App - Built a full-stack CRUD app using React, Express, Node.js, and MongoDB Atlas; implemented REST endpoints and simple auth; deployed frontend on Vercel. (2024)
- Next.js portfolio on Vercel showcasing class projects (SPC GUI, Pokedex, TODO, RAG demo) (2025)